ANSWER KEY

QP CODE: 25900914

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCPOL100 - INTRODUCTION TO INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. b). Preservation of National Interest

2. b). Geography

3. c). Education and Research /a). Counter-terrorism/ b). Climate change (covered these areas)

4. a). 1947, when India gained independence

5. c). Islamabad

6. a). 1-October-1949

7. b). COP-26

8. b). Information Technology

9. c). Indonesia

10. b). 1985

PART B

11. National security guides foreign policy- by ensuring territorial integrity- political stability- protection from external threats-shapes diplomatic decisions- defence partnerships- international alignments to safeguard sovereignty and promote peaceful coexistence.

12. Economic strength enhances a nation's bargaining power- global influence- development options-strong trade, industrial capacity, financial stability- enable countries to pursue independent foreign policies and secure favourable international agreements.

13. US opposed India's support for Bangladesh- viewing it as aligning with the Soviet Union- US sent the USS Enterprise to the Bay of Bengal- criticised India diplomatically- continued supporting Pakistan as part of its Cold War strategy.

14. India-Russia energy agreements support diversification of energy sources- stable oil supplies- nuclear cooperation- joint exploration-they reduce dependence on volatile markets- strengthen strategic ties- improve long-term energy security for India.

15. Economic boycott of China after Galwan had limited effectiveness-some imports reduced and certain apps were banned-but supply-chain dependence continued-India gained strategic awareness-yet structural reliance on Chinese goods remained.

16. Regional economic integration- boosts India's trade-connectivity- investment flows with neighbours-supports shared growth- reduces costs- strengthens political trust- enhances India's role in South Asian and Indo-Pacific regional frameworks.

17. India argues for a permanent UNSC seat- based on its large population- democratic credentials- major peacekeeping contributions- growing global economy-responsible nuclear power status- representation needs of developing nations.

18. India played an active role in TFA negotiations- advocating for food security safeguards, ensuring flexibility for developing countries- supporting trade-simplifying reforms- balanced domestic interests with global trade facilitation goals.

PART C

19. Modi's foreign policy highlights the Indian diaspora as strategic assets for soft power-investment- global outreach-through high-profile engagements- institutional support-initiatives like OCI reforms-the government strengthened cultural ties- economic links- India's influence in host countries, enhancing diplomatic leverage.

20. India's Cold War strategy- aimed to balance autonomy with pragmatic engagement-relations with the US fluctuated due to non-alignment and US-Pakistan ties- India secured economic assistance- technology cooperation- recognition of its strategic concerns-despite tensions, India preserved independence and avoided complete bloc alignment.

21. Neighbourhood First Policy- seeks regional stability- connectivity-cooperation- peaceful borders-India made progress through aid-infrastructure-security partnerships with Bhutan, Bangladesh, Maldives, and Sri Lanka-challenges persist with Pakistan and periodic tensions with Nepal-limiting full realisation of objectives.

22. India advocates UN reforms to make the organisation more democratic- representative-reflective of contemporary global power-pushes for expanded permanent membership-including itself-citing equity-effectiveness- developing-country voice-India argues that outdated structures weaken credibility and hinder timely global decision-making.